WORLD IN 1914 AND OUTBREAK OF WWI

ALLIANCE SYSTEM FORMATION → FOUR STRUCTURAL TENSIONS → BALKAN CRISIS LADDER → JULY TRIGGER AND FIRST → ESCALATION CHAIN → BALANCE-OF-POWER CASE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 ALLIANCE SYSTEM FORMATION

ALLIANCE SYSTEM FORMATION | TRIPLE ALLIANCE | GERMANY, AUSTRIA-HUNGARY, ITALY | FRANCE AND RUSSIA ALLY | ENTENTE CORDIALE | BRITAIN AND RUSSIA COMPLETE THE ENTENTE ALIGNMENT

1882 → Triple Alliance: Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy → 1894 → France and Russia ally → 1904 → Entente Cordiale → 1907 → Britain and Russia complete the Entente alignment

CORE CLAIM
- 1882 → Triple Alliance: Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy
- 1894 → France and Russia ally

MECHANISM
- 1904 → Entente Cordiale
- 1907 → Britain and Russia complete the Entente alignment

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1882 → Triple Alliance: Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy
- 1894 → France and Russia ally

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1907 → Britain and Russia complete the Entente alignment.

01

STAGE 01 FOUR STRUCTURAL TENSIONS

FOUR STRUCTURAL TENSIONS | NAVAL RACE | BRITAIN FEARS RELATIVE GERMAN SEA POWER | FRENCH REVANCHIST GRIEVANCE | GERMANY READS ENTENTE AS STRATEGIC PRESSURE | AUSTRIA AND RUSSIA COMPETE THROUGH SERBIA

NAVAL RACE → Britain fears relative German sea power → ALSACE-LORRAINE → French revanchist grievance → ENCIRCLEMENT → Germany reads Entente as strategic pressure → BALKANS → Austria and Russia compete through Serbia

CORE CLAIM
- NAVAL RACE → Britain fears relative German sea power
- ALSACE-LORRAINE → French revanchist grievance

MECHANISM
- ENCIRCLEMENT → Germany reads Entente as strategic pressure
- BALKANS → Austria and Russia compete through Serbia

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NAVAL RACE → Britain fears relative German sea power
- ALSACE-LORRAINE → French revanchist grievance

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BALKANS → Austria and Russia compete through Serbia.

02

STAGE 02 BALKAN CRISIS LADDER

BALKAN CRISIS LADDER | AUSTRIA-HUNGARY ANNEXES BOSNIA | AGADIR SHARPENS ANGLO-GERMAN MISTRUST | BALKAN WARS STRENGTHEN SERBIA | AUSTRIA SEEKS TO CURB SERBIAN NATIONALISM

1908 → Austria-Hungary annexes Bosnia → 1911 → Agadir sharpens Anglo-German mistrust → 1912-13 → Balkan Wars strengthen Serbia → 1914 → Austria seeks to curb Serbian nationalism

CORE CLAIM
- 1908 → Austria-Hungary annexes Bosnia
- 1911 → Agadir sharpens Anglo-German mistrust

MECHANISM
- 1912-13 → Balkan Wars strengthen Serbia
- 1914 → Austria seeks to curb Serbian nationalism

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1908 → Austria-Hungary annexes Bosnia
- 1911 → Agadir sharpens Anglo-German mistrust

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1914 → Austria seeks to curb Serbian nationalism.

03

STAGE 03 JULY TRIGGER AND FIRST DECISION

JULY TRIGGER AND FIRST DECISION | 28 JUNE | PRINCIP ASSASSINATES FRANZ FERDINAND AT SARAJEVO | AUSTRIA FRAMES DEMANDS SERBIA CANNOT FULLY ACCEPT | 28 JULY | AUSTRIA-HUNGARY DECLARES WAR ON SERBIA | ASSASSINATION TRIGGERS; VIENNA CHOOSES WAR

28 JUNE → Princip assassinates Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo → ULTIMATUM → Austria frames demands Serbia cannot fully accept → 28 JULY → Austria-Hungary declares war on Serbia → RULE → assassination triggers; Vienna chooses war

CORE CLAIM
- 28 JUNE → Princip assassinates Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo
- ULTIMATUM → Austria frames demands Serbia cannot fully accept

MECHANISM
- 28 JULY → Austria-Hungary declares war on Serbia
- RULE → assassination triggers; Vienna chooses war

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 28 JUNE → Princip assassinates Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo
- ULTIMATUM → Austria frames demands Serbia cannot fully accept

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 28 JULY → Austria-Hungary declares war on Serbia.

04

STAGE 04 ESCALATION CHAIN

ESCALATION CHAIN | GERMAN SUPPORT | AUSTRIA TAKES HARD LINE | RUSSIAN MOBILISATION | CONFLICT BECOMES GREAT-POWER CRISIS | 1/3 AUG | GERMANY DECLARES WAR ON RUSSIA AND FRANCE | 4 AUG

GERMAN SUPPORT → Austria takes hard line → RUSSIAN MOBILISATION → conflict becomes great-power crisis → 1/3 AUG → Germany declares war on Russia and France → 4 AUG → Belgium violated; Britain enters

CORE CLAIM
- GERMAN SUPPORT → Austria takes hard line
- RUSSIAN MOBILISATION → conflict becomes great-power crisis

MECHANISM
- 1/3 AUG → Germany declares war on Russia and France
- 4 AUG → Belgium violated; Britain enters

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- GERMAN SUPPORT → Austria takes hard line
- RUSSIAN MOBILISATION → conflict becomes great-power crisis

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1/3 AUG → Germany declares war on Russia and France.

05

STAGE 05 BALANCE-OF-POWER CASE

BALANCE-OF-POWER CASE | EUROPE DIVIDED INTO COUNTERWEIGHTS | GERMANY FEARS RELATIVE DECLINE | NAVAL RATIO | BRITAIN WATCHES CHANNEL AND FLEET BALANCE | EACH CRISIS SCORED AS A POWER TRANSFER

BLOCS → Europe divided into counterweights

ENCIRCLEMENT → Germany fears relative decline → NAVAL RATIO → Britain watches Channel and fleet balance → BALKANS → each crisis scored as a power transfer

CORE CLAIM
- BLOCS → Europe divided into counterweights
- ENCIRCLEMENT → Germany fears relative decline

MECHANISM
- NAVAL RATIO → Britain watches Channel and fleet balance
- BALKANS → each crisis scored as a power transfer

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BLOCS → Europe divided into counterweights
- ENCIRCLEMENT → Germany fears relative decline

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BALKANS → each crisis scored as a power transfer.

06

STAGE 06 MOTIVES BALANCE CANNOT ABSORB

MOTIVES BALANCE CANNOT ABSORB | MULTINATIONAL EMPIRE'S SURVIVAL | SOUTH SLAV NATIONAL UNIFICATION | ALSACE-LORRAINE REVANCHISM | PREVENTIVE TIMING AND PRESTIGE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
AUSTRIA → multinational empire's survival	FRANCE → Alsace-Lorraine revanchism	AUSTRIA → multinational empire's survival
SERBIA → South Slav national unification	GERMANY/RUSSIA → preventive timing and prestige	SERBIA → South Slav national unification

CORE CLAIM
- AUSTRIA → multinational empire's survival
- SERBIA → South Slav national unification

MECHANISM
- FRANCE → Alsace-Lorraine revanchism
- GERMANY/RUSSIA → preventive timing and prestige

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- AUSTRIA → multinational empire's survival
- SERBIA → South Slav national unification

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FRANCE → Alsace-Lorraine revanchism; GERMANY/RUSSIA → preventive timing and prestige.

07

STAGE 07 MOBILISATION AS MECHANISM

MOBILISATION AS MECHANISM | RUSSIA MOBILISES | GERMANY SEES NARROWING TIME | GERMAN PLAN | ATTACK FRANCE THROUGH BELGIUM | MILITARY SEQUENCE COMPRESSES DIPLOMACY | STRATEGIC PLANS WIDEN A REGIONAL WAR

RUSSIA MOBILISES → Germany sees narrowing time → GERMAN PLAN → attack France through Belgium → TIMETABLES → military sequence compresses diplomacy → RESULT → strategic plans widen a regional war

CORE CLAIM
- RUSSIA MOBILISES → Germany sees narrowing time
- GERMAN PLAN → attack France through Belgium

MECHANISM
- TIMETABLES → military sequence compresses diplomacy
- RESULT → strategic plans widen a regional war

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RUSSIA MOBILISES → Germany sees narrowing time
- GERMAN PLAN → attack France through Belgium

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → strategic plans widen a regional war.

08

STAGE 08 LIKELIHOOD VERSUS INEVITABILITY

LIKELIHOOD VERSUS INEVITABILITY | BLOCS, ARMS, BALKAN CRISES AND MISTRUST | NOT INEVITABLE | 1905-06, 1908 AND 1911 WERE CONTAINED | JULY LEADERS MAKE SPECIFIC RISKY CHOICES | STRUCTURE RAISES DANGER; AGENCY STARTS WAR

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LIKELY → blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust	BREAK → July leaders make specific risky choices	LIKELY → blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust
NOT INEVITABLE → 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained	VERDICT → structure raises danger; agency starts war	NOT INEVITABLE → 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained

CORE CLAIM
- LIKELY → blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust
- NOT INEVITABLE → 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained

MECHANISM
- BREAK → July leaders make specific risky choices
- VERDICT → structure raises danger; agency starts war

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LIKELY → blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust
- NOT INEVITABLE → 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → structure raises danger; agency starts war.

09

STAGE 09 RESPONSIBILITY AT TWO LEVELS

RESPONSIBILITY AT TWO LEVELS | VIENNA'S DECISION TO ATTACK SERBIA | BERLIN'S SUPPORT AND PREVENTIVE CALCULATION | RUSSIAN MOBILISATION AND GERMAN PLAN | ALLIANCES, NATIONALISM, PRESTIGE AND MILITARISATION

IMMEDIATE → Vienna's decision to attack Serbia

ENABLING → Berlin's support and preventive calculation → ESCALATORY → Russian mobilisation and German plan → SYSTEMIC → alliances, nationalism, prestige and militarisation

CORE CLAIM
- IMMEDIATE → Vienna's decision to attack Serbia
- ENABLING → Berlin's support and preventive calculation

MECHANISM
- ESCALATORY → Russian mobilisation and German plan
- SYSTEMIC → alliances, nationalism, prestige and militarisation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- IMMEDIATE → Vienna's decision to attack Serbia
- ENABLING → Berlin's support and preventive calculation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ESCALATORY → Russian mobilisation and German plan; SYSTEMIC → alliances, nationalism, prestige and militarisation.

10

STAGE 10 ITALY AND BRITAIN TRAPS

ITALY AND BRITAIN TRAPS | ALLIANCE MEMBER BUT NEUTRAL IN 1914; ALLIES IN 1915 | NO BINDING FRENCH ALLIANCE OBLIGATION | IMMEDIATE LEGAL-POLITICAL TRIGGER | ALIGNMENT, OBLIGATION AND ENTRY CAUSE ARE DIFFERENT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
ITALY → Alliance member but neutral in 1914; Allies in 1915	BELGIUM → immediate legal-political trigger	ITALY → Alliance member but neutral in 1914; Allies in 1915
BRITAIN → no binding French alliance obligation	RULE → alignment, obligation and entry cause are different	BRITAIN → no binding French alliance obligation

CORE CLAIM
- ITALY → Alliance member but neutral in 1914; Allies in 1915
- BRITAIN → no binding French alliance obligation

MECHANISM
- BELGIUM → immediate legal-political trigger
- RULE → alignment, obligation and entry cause are different

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- ITALY → Alliance member but neutral in 1914; Allies in 1915
- BRITAIN → no binding French alliance obligation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → alignment, obligation and entry cause are different.

11

STAGE 11 OUTBREAK ANSWER SPINE

OUTBREAK ANSWER SPINE | SARAJEVO, 28 JUNE | AUSTRO-SERB NATIONALITY CONFLICT | SUPPORT, MOBILISATION, BELGIUM | BALANCE STRUCTURE PLUS DISTINCT MOTIVES AND CHOICES

TRIGGER → Sarajevo, 28 June → REGIONAL → Austro-Serb nationality conflict → ESCALATION → support, mobilisation, Belgium → VERDICT → balance structure plus distinct motives and choices

CORE CLAIM
- TRIGGER → Sarajevo, 28 June
- REGIONAL → Austro-Serb nationality conflict

MECHANISM
- ESCALATION → support, mobilisation, Belgium
- VERDICT → balance structure plus distinct motives and choices

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- TRIGGER → Sarajevo, 28 June
- REGIONAL → Austro-Serb nationality conflict

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → balance structure plus distinct motives and choices.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | THE AUSTRO-SERB QUARREL SPARKED THE WAR | GERMAN BACKING OF AUSTRIA WAS CRUCIAL | RUSSIAN POLICY AND REARMAMENT ALSO HELPED MAKE GERMANY FEEL | USE THE OUTBREAK OF WAR AS THE SETTING FOR | CROSS-LINK INSTEAD OF DUPLICATING | MODERN-INDIAN-HISTORY/BASIC/18 WWI-HOME-RULE-AND-LUCKNOW-PACT.MD AND BASIC/19 GANDHIS-RISE-ROWLATT-AND-JALLIANWALA.MD. | IN ANSWERS, ONE SENTENCE IS ENOUGH

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- the Austro-Serb quarrel sparked the war;
- German backing of Austria was crucial;
- Russian policy and rearmament also helped make Germany feel pressed toward risk.
- CAUTION: Use the outbreak of war as the setting for later Indian wartime expectations of reform, loyalty and postwar disappointment.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- CAUTION: Cross-link instead of duplicating: Modern-Indian-History/basic/18 WWI-Home-Rule-and-Lucknow-Pact.md and basic/19 Gandhis-Rise-Rowlatt-and-Jallianwala.md.
- CAUTION: In answers, one sentence is enough: the war globalized European conflict and
- pulled colonies into a crisis whose political after-effects were felt far beyond Europe.
- Sarajevo assassination: 28 June 1914.

LEGACY / NUANCE
- Russia ordered general mobilization after Austria moved on Serbia.
- German support for Austria is described by Lowe as a "blank cheque".
- Belgian neutrality brought Britain directly into war.
- Lowe discusses Fischer, Zuber, Turner and Mulligan within the blame debate.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels